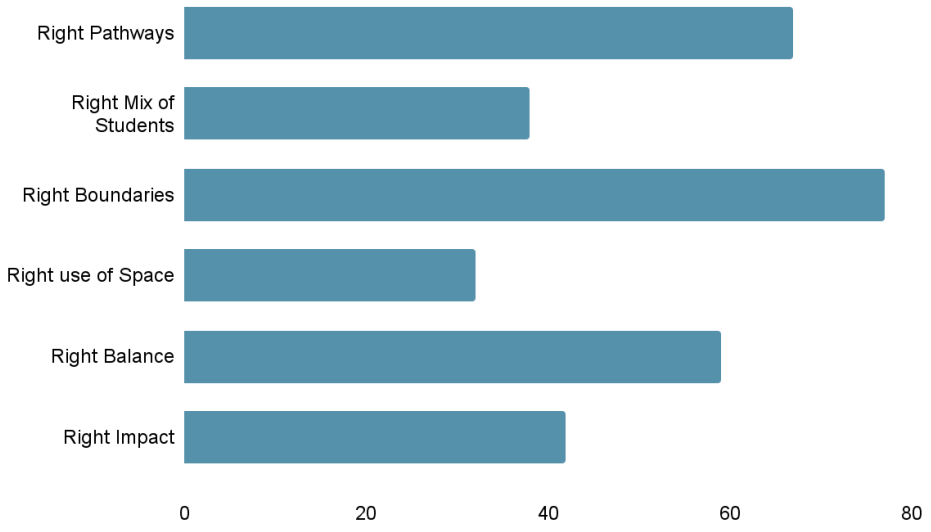
Board Engagement Summary at Roosevelt High School
April 27, 2026

Between 56-106 respondents answered each Slido question during the engagement session held at Roosevelt on April 27. While over 30 school communities were represented, Chief Joseph Elementary and James John Elementary were the most widely represented schools at this engagement session, and approximately 80% of participants were part of a K-5 school community. 5% of participants identified as African American/Black, 6% as American Indian/Alaska Native, 3% identified as Asian, 7% as Hispanic/Latino/Latinx, 1% as Middle Eastern/North African, 2% identified as Pacific Islander, 80% identified as white, 7% identified as multiracial, and 9% declined to answer this question. In total, 42% of participants reported that they had students who received special education services. Approximately 11% of participants had experienced a boundary change in school.

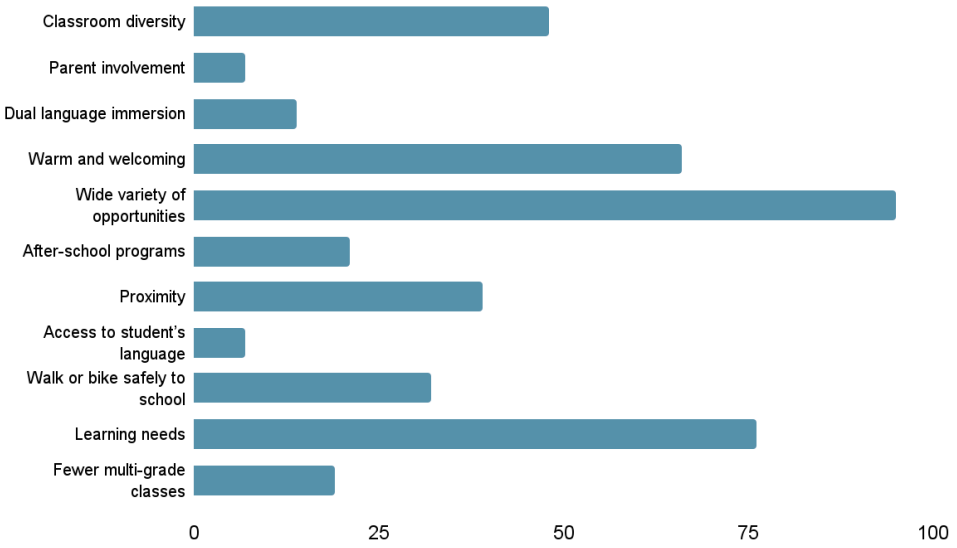
Of the six factors in the PPS student assignment policy, respondents prioritized compact boundaries that promote safer routes to schools and a sense of community as well as recognize and address natural and human-made barriers, feeder patterns that allow as many students as possible to continue together from one school level to the next, and program and enrollment stability in the surrounding schools over other factors. See Chart 1 for a breakdown of responses to this question.

Chart 1:
Responses to the question, "Our Portland Public Schools Student Assignment Policy asks us to consider the following six factors. Please select the three most important factors to consider during program and enrollment balancing across our system." (105 responses)



When asked to rank four factors that make a positive school environment, respondents identified a wide variety of learning opportunities, a warm and welcoming school environment, access to services that meet every student's learning need, and learning alongside children from different backgrounds as the highest priorities. See Chart 2 for a breakdown of responses to this question.

Chart 2:
Responses to the question, "select the top four factors that you think make a positive school environment" (106 responses)



58 respondents answered the question, "What has helped you/your student feel connected as they move from one school to the next?" Families shared that being part of a consistent cohort and having the opportunity to visit new schools and meet new teachers are essential for smooth transitions. Other key supports include building relationships with teachers and staff, having strong special education support, and being able to access specialized programs like CTE or the arts to keep students engaged.

Additionally, 62 families shared responses to the question, "In the past five years, has your family experienced a school transition that you initiated?" Families that chose to transition school environments left neighborhood schools for focus options or private alternatives due to persistent safety concerns, unaddressed bullying, and a lack of academic challenge for gifted students. Common frustrations driving these moves include high principal turnover and a lack of elective variety, leading



parents to prioritize consistency, smaller school settings, and the desire for stronger school-family communication. In this group of participants, there was a contingent of families that left private or charter school settings, choosing to send students to Portland Public Schools for its diverse communities, Title 1 supports, and specialized special education resources.

Overall, feedback from this listening session emphasized a desire for stability and equitable resource allocation after years of leadership turnover and institutional change. Families shared that school closures and boundary shifts disproportionately impact Title 1 schools and marginalized communities, who rely on schools as essential service hubs. To preserve the district's integrity, stakeholders urge leaders to prioritize long-term consistency, protect lifeline programs like dual language immersion and special education, and shift the focus from "vocal, wealthy parents" to the needs of historically underinvested neighborhoods.